

# Foot Pain - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1502 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

## Definition

- UAT-only adult and pediatric non-traumatic foot-pain pathway screening for infection, inability to bear weight, neurovascular compromise and diabetic or immune risk before in-person assessment.
- Child patient.
- Female.

## Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where exactly is the pain?
2. [DURATION] How long has the pain lasted?
3. [YES\_NO] Is the skin around the foot swollen and hot?
4. [OPEN\_TEXT] What is the age; is there diabetes/neuropathy, immune/vascular disease, wound/foreign body, inability to bear weight, pregnancy/postpartum status, hidden trauma, neurovascular change or child safeguarding concern?
5. [CAREGIVER\_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

## Triage and redirect questions

### **1. Redirect → Motor Vehicle Accident**

Did this joint problem begin with a motor vehicle crash or as part of a multi-system crash injury?

A motor vehicle crash or multi-system crash injury belongs in the Motor Vehicle Accident pathway.

### **1. Disposition level 100**

Is foot pain severe with inability to bear weight or a cold/pale/blue/numb foot, or is there a diabetic/other wound or hot swelling plus marked systemic illness or rapid deterioration?

NHS.UK joint pain guidance lists swelling/heat and feeling unwell as reasons for urgent review; diabetic foot problems specifically need prompt assessment given the higher risk of complications.

### **1. Disposition level 70**

With no emergency feature, is there any persistent or unexplained foot pain, wound, swelling, walking limitation, diabetes/immune risk, child concern or higher-risk context?

In-person assessment is required, particularly for diabetes/neuropathy, wounds, immune risk, children and impaired weight bearing.

## Advice

### **Qatar emergency foot response**

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for systemic illness with hot swelling, inability to bear weight, severe rapidly worsening pain, or a cold/pale/blue/numb foot. Do not allow self-driving. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: increasing swelling or redness; fever or neurovascular change.

### **In-person foot assessment**

- Arrange in-person assessment, especially for a child, pregnancy, diabetes, neuropathy, immune compromise or skin break. Protect from pressure and do not use fixed-dose analgesia until patient factors are checked.
- Call Back If: pain persists or worsens; swelling, redness or fever.

## First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for systemic illness with hot swelling, inability to bear weight, severe rapidly worsening pain, or a cold/pale/blue/numb foot. Do not allow self-driving. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

## References

- NHS.UK, "Joint pain", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/joint-pain/> (page last reviewed 26 February 2026) - applied to non-traumatic foot pain

## Provenance

Shaped to mirror the licensed After-Hours Telehealth Triage Guidelines database structure. This is IST open-source guideline content derived from cited public sources; it is not licensed STCC content. Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline redirect. Demographic variants contain only source-supported differences; identical thresholds are documented rather than fabricated. Local destinations and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

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